II CHAPTER II

OFFICE AUTOMATION

Content:

Introduction – Meaning of Automation – Objectives of Automation – Merits and Demerits of Automation – Modern Equipment Used in an Office –Factors to be Considered for Selecting Various Equipment – Office Furniture, Fittings and Accessories – Principles in Selecting the Office Furniture.

Learning Objectives

- Enable the students to gain awareness about the concept of Automation.
- To acquaint the students about the various factors to be considered in selecting office appliances, furniture's, filing and accessories.

Introduction:

As discussed in the earlier chapter, the term office has undergone drastic changes. "The Office is now in a period of transition" where more and more information processing functions are being automated through sophisticated electronic systems. New electronic procedures and systems becoming more and more popular in modern Automated Office which otherwise called as "Paperless Office". A 'Paperless Office' is one in which paper has been replaced by electronic, digital, micrographic and micro processing systems.

This Paperless Office incorporates voice inputs, word processing, optical character recognition, electronic mail, calendars, message sending, filing directions and text editing, computer indexing and processing, telecommunications and colour graphics systems into a fully automated office facility. Several Modern Offices provide satellite communication video teleconferences, electronic mail and computer-to-computer hook-ups for intra-company use. This chapter focuses on office automation and various modern equipment used in modern office.

2.1. Automation:

2.1.1. Meaning:

Automation may be described as usage of advanced technology with the help of specific devices of communication and control in self-regulation without human intervention. It can also be termed as application of information technology to the typical clerical and secretarial tasks such as communication, correspondence, documenting and filing.

2.1.2. Definition:

Business Dictionary defines the term office automation as "Method or

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